

E058

Stakeholder Communication and Collaboration

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer _____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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Items

1.

A project team has 8 members. The sponsor, who works remotely from Portland, joins the team, and so does a new business analyst hired from a competitor. How many communication channels does the team now have?

- A. 28
- B. 17
- C. 90
- D. 45

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A team currently has 15 communication channels. How many people are on the team?

- A. 7.5
- B. 6
- C. 15
- D. 30

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A regional vice president controls the project's funding but rarely asks about it because she is focused on a merger. She played college tennis and prefers short emails. Where does she fall on the power/interest grid, and what strategy fits?

- A. High power, low interest: keep satisfied.
- B. High power, high interest: manage closely.
- C. Low power, low interest: monitor.
- D. Low power, high interest: keep informed.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which stakeholder should the project manager keep informed?

- A.** A board member with veto power who rarely follows the project.
- B.** The CFO who approves the budget and watches every milestone.
- C.** Front-line users who care a lot about the new system but have little authority over it.
- D.** A supplier with no authority and no interest in the project.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

A department head knows about the project but says it will create extra work, and she has quietly told staff not to volunteer for testing. Her office is next to the project management office. The desired engagement level for her is supportive. What is her current engagement level?

- A.** Resistant.
- B.** Neutral.
- C.** Supportive.
- D.** Unaware.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

A 3,000-employee company is rolling out a new expense tool. The project manager wants all employees to be able to look up how-to guides and FAQs whenever they need them. The rollout team uses a purple logo on all materials. Which communication method fits?

- A.** Push, because every employee must always receive every guide.
- B.** Push communication, such as emailing every guide.
- C.** Interactive communication, such as live meetings with all 3,000.
- D.** Pull communication, such as an intranet knowledge base.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which situation calls for interactive communication rather than push or pull?

- A.** Resolving a disagreement between two department heads about requirements.
- B.** Sending a weekly status email to executives.
- C.** Posting monthly status reports to a shared site.
- D.** Publishing a project glossary for new hires.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

A project manager is writing a communications plan. The executive sponsor wants to know only whether the project is on budget and on schedule; the development team needs daily task detail. The project manager's favorite format is a 30-page status report. What should the plan do?

- A. Send everyone the 30-page report so no one misses anything.
- B. Give the sponsor daily task detail, since the sponsor is most senior.
- C. Tailor content, format, and frequency by audience, such as a one-page dashboard for the sponsor and daily stand-ups for developers.
- D. Send one identical weekly report to everyone for consistency.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

On a RACI chart for “approve test plan,” the QA lead, the project manager, and the business owner are all marked A. The QA lead holds the most testing certifications on the team. What is wrong?

- A. Nothing; the QA lead's certifications make three A's acceptable.
- B. All three should be marked R instead of A.
- C. Every activity must also have exactly one C and one I.
- D. Only one person should be Accountable for each activity.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

In a RACI chart, a person who must be asked for input before a decision and gives two-way feedback holds which role?

- A. Responsible.
- B. Informed.
- C. Consulted.
- D. Accountable.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

A project manager emails a detailed scope change to an offshore team in a different time zone. The team replies “OK” but builds the wrong feature. The email had a professional signature and the company logo. What would best have prevented this?

- A.** Make the receiver fully responsible for decoding the message.
- B.** Confirm understanding, such as asking the team to summarize the change back or holding a short call.
- C.** Use a more formal email template.
- D.** Communicate only in writing, since writing removes all misunderstanding.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

Two team leads, who both joined the company the same year, disagree about whether to build a feature in-house or buy it. Both have valid concerns about cost and long-term support, and there are three weeks before the design freeze. Which approach most likely yields a lasting solution?

- A.** Compromise, each giving up part of what they want.
- B.** Collaborate to solve the problem, addressing both leads' concerns.
- C.** Emphasize areas of agreement and avoid the core question.
- D.** Have the project manager decide and move on.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer D Concept 1

A project team has 8 members. The sponsor, ~~who works remotely from Portland~~, joins the team, and so does a new business analyst ~~hired from a competitor~~. How many communication channels does the team now have?

Target word: total channels after growth **Decides:** n is now 10.

A	Wrong stem number	Uses the original 8 people: $8 \times 7 / 2$.
B	Adjacent category	The number of channels added ($45 - 28$), not the total.
C	Dropped element	10×9 without dividing by 2 double-counts each channel.
D	Correct	$10 \times 9 / 2 = 45$.

2. Answer B Concept 1 • transfer

A team currently has 15 communication channels. How many people are on the team?

Target word: solve for n **Decides:** $n(n - 1) / 2 = 15$.

A	Inverted operation	Divides 15 by 2 instead of solving the formula.
B	Correct	$6 \times 5 / 2 = 15$.
C	Wrong stem number	That is the number of channels.
D	Dropped element	Stops at $n(n - 1) = 30$ without solving for n.

3. Answer A Concept 2

A regional vice president controls the project's funding but rarely asks about it because she is focused on a merger. ~~She played college tennis~~ and prefers short emails. Where does she fall on the power/interest grid, and what strategy fits?

Target word: grid quadrant and strategy **Decides:** High power, low interest.

A	Correct	Meet her needs without overloading her with detail.
B	Adjacent category	She controls funding but is not actively interested.
C	Dropped element	Ignores that she controls the funding.
D	Inverted operation	Reverses both dimensions.

4. Answer C Concept 2 • transfer

Which stakeholder should the project manager keep informed?

Target word: work backward from strategy to stakeholder **Decides:** Keep informed = low power, high interest.

A	Inverted operation	High power, low interest: keep satisfied.
B	Adjacent category	High power, high interest: manage closely.
C	Correct	Low power, high interest.
D	Confusion set	Low power, low interest: monitor.

5. Answer A Concept 3

A department head knows about the project but says it will create extra work, and she has quietly told staff not to volunteer for testing. ~~Her office is next to the project management office.~~ The desired engagement level for her is supportive. What is her current engagement level?

Target word: current engagement level **Decides:** Aware and actively working against the project.

A	Correct	Aware of the project and opposing it.
B	Adjacent category	Neutral stakeholders are aware but neither support nor oppose.
C	Confusion set	That is the desired level, not her current one.
D	Dropped element	Ignores that she already knows about the project.

6. Answer D Concept 4

A 3,000-employee company is rolling out a new expense tool. The project manager wants all employees to be able to look up how-to guides and FAQs whenever they need them. ~~The rollout team uses a purple logo on all materials.~~ Which communication method fits?

Target word: communication method **Decides:** Large audience, accessed on demand.

A	Absolute language	Not everyone needs every guide at once.
B	Confusion set	Push sends to recipients; it does not fit on-demand lookup.
C	Adjacent category	Real-time exchange is impractical for on-demand reference.
D	Correct	Large audiences access reference content when they need it.

7. Answer A Concept 4 · transfer

Which situation calls for interactive communication rather than push or pull?

Target word: work backward from method to situation **Decides:** Interactive = real-time, two-way.

A	Correct	Needs real-time, two-way discussion.
B	Adjacent category	That is push.
C	Confusion set	That is pull.
D	Dropped element	One-way reference content; lacks the real-time exchange.

8. Answer C Concept 5

A project manager is writing a communications plan. The executive sponsor wants to know only whether the project is on budget and on schedule; the development team needs daily task detail. ~~The project manager's favorite format is a 30-page status report.~~ What should the plan do?

Target word: plan design **Decides:** Two audiences need different content and frequency.

A	Camouflage	The manager's preferred format does not decide what audiences need.
B	Inverted operation	Reverses who needs detail and who needs a summary.
C	Correct	Each group gets what it needs.
D	Dropped element	Drops audience analysis.

9. Answer D Concept 6

On a RACI chart for “approve test plan,” the QA lead, the project manager, and the business owner are all marked A. ~~The QA lead holds the most testing certifications on the team.~~ What is wrong?

Target word: RACI error **Decides:** Three people marked Accountable.

A	Camouflage	Credentials do not change the one-A rule.
B	Confusion set	Removes accountability entirely; someone must own the outcome.
C	Absolute language	Consulted and Informed can be zero or many.
D	Correct	A single owner prevents confusion over who signs off.

10. Answer C Concept 6 · transfer

In a RACI chart, a person who must be asked for input before a decision and gives two-way feedback holds which role?

Target word: work backward from description to role **Decides:** Two-way input before a decision.

A	Adjacent category	Responsible parties do the work.
B	Confusion set	Informed parties receive one-way updates.
C	Correct	Consulted parties give two-way input.
D	Inverted operation	The decision owner, not the adviser.

11. Answer B Concept 7

A project manager emails a detailed scope change to an offshore team in a different time zone. The team replies “OK” but builds the wrong feature. ~~The email had a professional signature and the company logo.~~ What would best have prevented this?

Target word: prevent misunderstanding **Decides:** No check that the message was understood.

A	Inverted operation	The sender is responsible for clarity and for confirming understanding.
B	Correct	Feedback closes the loop in the communication model.
C	Camouflage	Formatting was not the problem.
D	Absolute language	Written messages can still be misread.

12. Answer B Concept 8

Two team leads, ~~who both joined the company the same year,~~ disagree about whether to build a feature in-house or buy it. Both have valid concerns about cost and long-term support, and there are three weeks before the design freeze. Which approach most likely yields a lasting solution?

Target word: best conflict mode **Decides:** Valid concerns on both sides and time available.

A	Adjacent category	Partial satisfaction; the underlying issue may return.
B	Correct	Problem solving addresses root causes and builds commitment.
C	Dropped element	Smoothing drops the real disagreement.
D	Confusion set	Forcing is quick but rarely lasting.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	7	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	2	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	8	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	6	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	3	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	7	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	3	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Communication channels	Channels = $n(n - 1) / 2$, where n counts everyone communicating, so channels grow much faster than headcount.	Forgetting to divide by 2 or using the old headcount.	"How many communication channels."
2	Power/interest grid	High power + high interest: manage closely; high power + low interest: keep satisfied; low power + high interest: keep informed; low + low: monitor.	Swapping "keep satisfied" and "keep informed."	A stakeholder's authority and level of attention both described.
3	Engagement assessment matrix	Engagement levels run unaware, resistant, neutral, supportive, leading; the plan closes the gap between current and desired.	Reading the desired level as the current one.	Current behavior plus a stated goal level.
4	Push, pull, and interactive communication	Push sends to specific people; pull posts for people to access when needed; interactive is real-time, two-way exchange.	Using push for large reference content or for resolving disagreements.	"Look up whenever they need" vs. "resolve."
5	Tailoring the communications plan	Content, format, and frequency are tailored to each stakeholder group's needs.	One report for everyone.	Two audiences wanting different levels of detail.
6	RACI roles	Responsible does the work; Accountable owns the outcome (only one per task); Consulted gives two-way input; Informed is kept up to date.	Several people marked Accountable, or confusing Consulted and Informed.	A RACI chart or "who signs off."
7	Feedback in the communication model	The sender is responsible for clear encoding and for confirming the message was understood.	Treating "OK" as proof of understanding.	A message acknowledged but acted on wrongly.
8	Conflict resolution modes	Collaborating (problem solving) addresses the root cause and tends to produce lasting results; compromise, smoothing, forcing, and withdrawing are partial or temporary.	Treating compromise as the ideal.	Both sides have valid concerns and there is time to work it out.

Course scope (public description): In Stakeholder Communication and Collaboration, the learner will develop a stakeholder communications strategy to effectively engage and inform project stakeholders. Learners will facilitate communication and collaboration among internal and external project stakeholders, fostering strong relationships and promoting project success. Additionally, the learner will explore project management tools to manage stakeholder communication and collaboration, ensuring effective information sharing, feedback mechanisms, and stakeholder engagement throughout the project lifecycle.